

comforts of one's room, getting out of the house, negotiating the traffic of the city, reaching the nearest shopping area, scouting for the product and then finally, buying that item.

With online shopping, you save priceless time, energy and money. And if you're still not convinced about the impact of e-commerce in India, Google 'future of ecommerce in India'. We did, and within 0.17 seconds, reality was staring us in the face. Google bombarded us with 6,490,000 results.

Chances are you've probably already bought a cartload of wares from online stores. Chances are equally bright that you've also convinced one of the many emperors of the orthodox around us to buy goods online, just like you do. And even if you've shyed away from buying online till now, you're not late. The e-commerce story has just begun and you haven't missed much.

The digital story

You may be surprised to learn that by the end of this year around 150 million Indians will have access to the internet (as per latest figures released by market research leader IMRB and the Internet and Mobile Association of India (IAMAI)). By the same time, the population of active users would have reached 111 million.

With such a staggering number of netizens in India, it shouldn't surprise us that reliable estimates peg the current e-commerce market in India at Rs 50,000 crores and expect its worth to shoot up to Rs 120,000 crores by 2015. And this is when only a little over 10% of the online population uses the internet for purchases. The count is only going to increase. The prime factors fueling the growth may be the convenience of shopping, teamed with better internet connectivity and an increasing number of people coming to terms with online shopping. Speaking about connectivity, industry insiders

